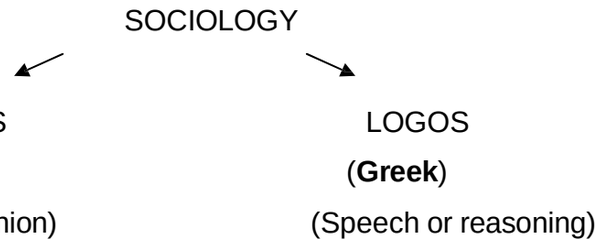
FUNDAMENTALS OF RURAL SOCIOLOGY AND AGRICULTURAL EDUCATIONAL

LECTURE NO.: 1. SOCIOLOGY AND RURAL SOCIOLOGY, EXTENSION EDUCATION, AGRICULTURAL EXTENSION - MEANING AND DEFINITIONS

Sociology – Introduction:

The term sociology was coined by ***Auguste Comte (1789-1875)*** who is often referred as the **father of sociology** who named it from **two** words, of which one is **Latin** word '**socius**' meaning **companion** and the other is **Greek** word '**logos**' meaning **speech or reasoning**.



The etymological (based on the origin of the word) meaning of sociology is thus '**the science of society**'. **Sociology** has been referred to as systematized knowledge in the study of human social relationships. The content or subject matter of sociology is not literary writing as is assured (thought) by many people. It is a detailed and systematic study of society. There are animal societies also but sociology studies only human societies. Human beings have progressed to a large extent and therefore, sociology is used for the systematic study of the human being in **group relations.** Sociology is concerned with people and without people or human beings there cannot be sociology, it cannot be in **isolation** as its main emphasis is on their relationship with other persons. They stay in groups and therefore the sociologists study people organized in families, friendship groups, temples, schools, industrial plants and in other organizations. The fundamental process in any society is **interaction** or **social interaction**. In short sociology studies the social behavior of people, their different social groups and the intra and interrelationship of these social groups. **Sociology** is the **web** or tissue of human **interaction** and **interrelationship** – **Ginsburg**

Definitions and scope of Rural Sociology or what is rural sociology:

Rural sociology is a **branch** of sociology. It is made up of two terms **rural** and **sociology** that is **science** of rural society. It is the study of the sociology of life in the rural environment, which systematically studies the rural communities to discover their conditions and tendencies and formulate the principles of progress as the term implies. It is limited to the study of various aspects of rural society.

Definition: According to **Smith** rural sociology is the body of facts and principles of the systematized knowledge, which has developed the application of scientific method in the study of human relationships in rural environment and people, engaged directly or indirectly in agriculture occupation. An extension worker is a **change** agent. Transfer or communication of innovations is the main job of these changes agents. But for introducing improved farm practices, an understanding of the farmer, his social and cultural environment within which he operates, his home, his village and the local region is necessary.

Rural sociology provides such knowledge and makes possible the planning of a strategic approach for the desired changes. It allows constant analysis of the rural situation and within reasonable limits prediction of possible results. From this point of view the main emphasis in the community development programs is on changing human behavior and working with rural people by using educational methods. For doing this, as stated earlier the change agent, must have adequate knowledge and skill in methods of **communication**. In addition to this the change agent must know what is going on, in the minds of rural people, their relationships and interactions, their groups, their institutions, their organizations and the culture they share. All these factors influence the farmers' behavior. The knowledge regarding these factors is provided by rural sociology. In the absence of this knowledge of rural society the change agent will not be able to plan a proper strategy of change. The change agent at the first instance has to understand their programmes and their objectives. Secondly he must know the currents of thoughts in the minds of the people with whom he works. He needs to understand their motives, their reactions and their receptivity to new ideas. He should also understand why some people are more receptive than others, why some people take the initiative and lead and why others hesitate

Scope of Rural Sociology: Rural sociology works in three areas

a. Accumulation and use of sociological knowledge and use it for solving the present problems of rural society (subject matter of rural sociology)
b. Direct its efforts in obtaining sociological knowledge by empirical research procedures (research in rural sociology)
c. Channel its efforts by keeping faith in the methods used in this discipline in solving the problems of rural society (solving the problems of rural society)

Rural Sociology – its importance to extension work:

1. In the context of **community development** and rural development programs deliberate efforts are made to bring about social change in rural areas. This change is brought about not in a **vacuum** but in a structure of human relations, which necessitates the study of rural sociology

2. An extension worker is a change agent. He has to bring about **changes** in the rural culture. Therefore, he has to understand the culture in which he has to bring about changes
3. In the **cross-cultural situation**, it is likely that the change agent may develop the **ethnocentric attitude**, which makes him difficult to work successfully. Study of rural sociology helps to overcome this difficulty.
4. Some times. The change agent, while working in rural communities, does not keep the **established pattern of hierarchy**, this creates problems in his working. Rural sociology helps him to understand the same and its importance
5. The **value system** of individuals, families, groups and communities is an important factor to be kept in mind while trying to bring about changes in the farming communities

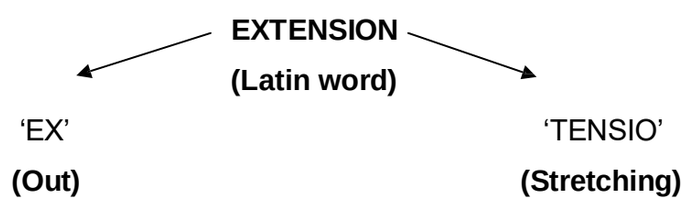
Therefore, it is necessary for a student of rural development to study the subject of rural sociology to bring about planned change in the rural communities effectively and without resistance

LECTURE NO.: 2. IMPORTANCE OF RURAL SOCIOLOGY IN AGRICULTURAL EXTENSION AND THEIR INTERRELATIONSHIP

Extension education (Agricultural Extension) in the field of agriculture is concerned with agricultural education aimed at assisting people to bring about **continuous** improvement in their physical and social well being through individual and cooperative efforts. It makes available to the villagers, scientific information and also guidance in the application of such information in solving their problems. Villagers are **educated** to change their attitudes so as to raise their standard of living

Meaning of Extension Education:

The word Extension is derived from the **Latin** roots '**Ex**' meaning '**out**' and '**tensio**' meaning '**stretching**'. Thus the term extension education means the type of education, which is stretched out into the villages and fields beyond the limits of schools and colleges to which formal type of education is normally confined. In other words the word 'extension' used in this context signifies an ***OUT OF SCHOOL*** system of education. The three links in the chain of rural development are ***research, teaching*** and ***extension***



Definition:

Extension education is the process of **teaching** rural people how to **live** better by learning **ways** that improve their farm, home and community institutions

INTERRELATIONSHIP BETWEEN RURAL SOCIOLOGY AND EXTENSION

S.No.	Rural Sociology	Extension
1.	It is a **scientific study** of the laws of the structure and development of rural society	It is **informal** (actually non-formal) education for the rural people with a view to **develop** rural society on desirable lines
2.	It studies the **attitudes** and behavior of rural people	It seeks to **modify** or change for the better, the attitudes and behavior of village people
3.	It studies the **needs** and interests of rural society	It helps rural people to **discover** their needs and problems and **builds educational programs** based on these needs and wants
4.	It analyses rural **social relationships,** or group organizations and **leadership** in rural areas, the **social processes** like cooperation, association, competition etc, among village people	It **fosters** (develops) and utilizes **village organizations** and leadership and **favorable** social processes, to achieve its objectives of rural development
5.	It studies **social situations** and assembles social facts or rural society	It makes **use** of such **social data** as a basis for building up its **extension programs** for rural areas
6.	It **investigates** the social, cultural, political, and religious **problems** of rural society	It also studies these problems with reference to their **impact on extension work** in villages

LECTURE NO.: 3. CHARACTERISTICS RURAL SOCIETY, DIFFERENCES AND RELATIONSHIPS BETWEEN RURAL AND URBAN SOCIETIES

Need for the Study of the Rural Society:

1. The study of **rural society** is essential for carrying out a **programme** of rural extension
2. It is important to know some of the characteristics of rural society as people have **distinguishing** features
3. A knowledge of fundamental characteristics of rural situation should contribute much to the **understanding** of the structure of rural society, the way it functions
4. Rural people are studied in terms of their personal and group relations and as members of groups, organizations and institutions
5. Rural society comprises of all persons residing in administrative unit of village as defined by the authorities

Definition of Society:

Society is defined as a group of people in more or less **permanent** association who are organized for their **collective** activities and who feel that they **belong** together

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN RURAL AND URBAN COMMUNITIES

Rural people are different from those living in urban areas. These differences are mainly due to the environment and its consequent impact on the lives of the people

S.No.	Item of comparison	Rural community	Urban community
1.	General environment and orientation to nature	Closely associated with nature. Direct effect of natural elements like rains, drought, heat, etc, on their lives	Remote from nature. Predominance of man-made environment
2.	Occupation	Major occupation is farming. Non-agricultural occupations are secondary in importance	Most of the jobs are non-agricultural and specialized
3.	Working conditions	Being **agriculture** work in open air	Work in closed environment. Greater isolation from nature. Poor fresh air
4.	Family	Works as a unit. More unity or integrity and more contacts between members	Work in different occupations and contact is less between members
5.	Size of the community	'Agriculturalism' and size of community are negatively correlated. Community is small in size. Land to man ratio is Higher	Large. Less land per person
6.	Density of population	Low density of population	High density of population
7.	Material possession	Less	Different types and more
8.	Homogeneity and heterogeneity	More homogeneous. Similarity in social and psychological characteristics in the population. Such as beliefs, language etc,	More heterogeneous. Wide variety of interests, occupations, languages etc.
9.	Social institutions	Most of the institutions are a natural outgrowth of rural social life. Less of enacted (approved or created) institutions	Numerous enacted institutions
10.	Social stratification and differentiation	Less among groups and low degree of differentiation. Gap between higher and lower classes is less	Different types of groups like professional, occupational etc, and high degree of differentiation. Gap between the higher and lower classes is more

11.	Hierarchy	Less in number e.g. lower, middle and upper classes	More in number e.g. upper-upper, upper-middle, upper-lower, middle upper and so on
12.	Social contacts and type	Less number, social interaction is narrow. Primary contacts are more predominant. Personal and relatively durable relations. Man is interacted as a human	Large number, social interaction is wider. Secondary contacts are predominant. Impersonal, casual and short-lived relations. Man is interacted as number and address
13.	Social mobility	Occupational and territorial mobility is less intensive. Normally the migration current carries more individuals from countryside to the cities	Occupational and territorial mobility is found more intensive. Urbanity and social mobility are positively correlated. Only in the period of social crises migration is from cities to countryside
14.	Social control	Informal control i.e. more related to the values and traditions of the society	Formal control i.e. legally
15.	Social change	Rural life is relatively static and Stable	Urban social life is under constant social change
16.	Social solidarity (unity)	Strong sense of belonging and unity due to common objectives, similarities and personal relationships	Comparatively less sense of belonging and unity due to dissimilarities and impersonal kinds of relationships
17.	Standard of living	Low standard of living,	High standard of living
18.	Educational facilities	Less	More
19.	Economy	Subsistence	Cash
20.	Communication	Less transport facilities, bad roads etc	Many transport facilities, better roads, communication etc
21.	Society	A simple, uni-group society	A complex, multi-group society
22.	Culture	Sacred	Secular (all religions are equal)

LECTURE NO.: 4. SOCIAL GROUP/S - CLASSIFICATION, FORMATION AND ORGANIZATION OF GROUPS, ROLE OF SOCIAL GROUPS IN AGRICULTURAL EXTENSION

Social structure is composed of **groups**. Organizations, institutions, community etc, are the forms of human associations. Society functions through different forms of human beings to fulfill needs and purposes. Man functions in society through different forms of groups. Man is born is a **social group** and his first association is with his mother. He associates with groups in some way or other. Individual nowhere lives in isolation. This tendency to unite in groups is one of the important characteristics of human beings. **Social groups** are the units out of which society is constructed. Study of group is of primary important in the study of society and also important as a part of the total structure of society. **Group** is a medium through which we learn **culture**. The process of socialization takes place in groups

Definitions of Group:

a **social group** is a unit of two or more people in reciprocal (to and fro) interaction and in communication with each other

A social group as a collection of human beings who enter into distinctive social relationships with one another

A**social group** is a collection of two or more individuals in which there are psychological interactions and reciprocal roles based upon durable contacts, shared norms, interests, distinctive pattern of collective behavior and structural organization of leadership and followership

Elements of Social Group:

1. Social unit
2. Psychological interactions and reciprocal roles
3. Durable contacts
4. Distinctive pattern of collective behavior
5. Sharing of norms and interests
6. Pattern of leadership and follower ship

Types or classification of Social Groups:

Type of group/s	Based on
Primary and Secondary groups	The type of relationship
Formal and Informal groups	Mode of organization and functioning
Voluntary and involuntary groups	Structure and type of membership
Horizontal and vertical groups	Social class
In and out groups	Personal feelings
Locality groups	Territory or locality
Small and large groups	Size
Reference group	

Based on the type of **relationship** groups are dived in to primary and secondary groups**:** Primary groups are **relationship** directed whereas secondary groups are **goal** oriented

Primary Group	Secondary Group
Small in size, often less than 20 to 30 Persons	Large in size
Personal and intimate relationships among members are there	Impersonal and aloof(distant) relationships among members
Face to face association is there between the members	Less face to face contact
Permanency is there and members are together over a long period of time	Temporary in nature. Members spend relatively little time together
Members are well acquainted and have a strong sense of loyalty or 'we' feeling and a strong amount of group pressure is present	Members are not well acquainted and anonymity prevails
Informality is most common i.e. group does not have any name, officers etc	Formality prevails i.e. group often has a name, officers and a regular meeting place
Group decisions are more traditional and non rational	Group decisions are more rational and the emphasis is on efficiency
E.g. family, friendship group, play group etc	E.g. political groups, labour unions, trade unions, employees associations etc

Based on **mode of organization** and **functioning** groups are divided in to formal and informal groups:

Formal Group	Informal Group
These are formally organized and have prescribed structure i.e. constitution by-laws etc	These are not formally organized and lack prescribed structure
E.g. Labour union, village council, students union etc	E.g. family, friendship group, play group etc

Based on **structure** and **type of membership** groups are divided in to voluntary, involuntary and delegate groups:

Voluntary Group	Involuntary Group
A person becomes member of the group based on his choice	Persons become members of the group not according to their choice i.e. by birth, by residence, by location etc
E.g. friendship group, play group etc	E.g. family, neighbourhood, community etc.

Delegate group: The members of this group are representative and chosen by groups. E.g. Gram Panchayat, U.N.O., etc.

Based on **social class** groups are divided in the horizontal and vertical groups:

Horizontal Group	Vertical Group
The members of this group are alike or similar in status or position in the class system of the society	The groups that are composed of members from different social strata (social status) and whose membership cuts vertically across the horizontal groupings in the society
E.g. caste	E.g. race, nation etc

Based on **personal feelings** the groups have been divided in and out groups:

In Group	Out Group
Persons in this group feel that they belong to that group based on their attitudes of the members towards their own social groups	Persons in this group do not feel that they belong to that group based on their attitudes
E.g. my family, my class, my church etc.	E.g. their family, their class, their church etc.

Based on the size of the groups the groups are divided in to small and large groups:

Small Group	Large Group
The number of members is less than 30	The number of members is more
E.g. family, play group etc.	E.g. political group, labour union etc.

Locality Group:

This classification considers **locality** as one bond for holding groups together or it is based on the territory or locality occupied by the members. E.g. neighbourhoods, communities or villages towns etc

Reference Group:

In this group the individual feels **identified** with the group but he **may or may not** be the member of the group, the group influences individual. He shares the objectives of this group, which he accepts. The reference group provides the **standards** that guide behavior even when the standards are contrary to earlier membership groups. To understand the behavior of human beings we must know their reference groups. A reference group may be any group for E.g. Primary group, horizontal group etc. Reference group like friendship group may influence a farmer to accept or reject the adoption of an improved farming practice. **Reference group** is the group which the individual refers for advises on different aspects. An individual may have different reference groups for different purposes. In rural society the individual belongs to a comparatively small number of groups (largely primary) and his behavior is largely determined by them

LECTURE NO.: 5. SOCIAL STRATIFICATION - MEANING, FORMS, CLASS SYSTEM AND CASTE SYSTEM

Definitions:

Social stratification is the division of population into **two** or **more** layers, each of which is relatively **homogeneous** and between which there are differences in privileges (opportunities), restrictions, rewards and obligations.

A pattern of superimposed categories of differential privilege is termed as **social stratification – .** The moment of individuals or groups from one **stratum** of society to another is known as **social mobility.**

Communities are socially stratified in various ways. Sex division is a major sociological difference, age groups and so on. Society is divided into layers, some of which occupy a **higher** position than others. These layers are generally accepted as **social classes**. So the principal type of social stratification is seen in the phenomenon of '**class**'. The term **CLASS** means a number of individuals in the same society whose status is **similar**. Social status refers to positions of individual or group in **relation** to other. As a sociological concept, social status is the difference between higher and lower. A **social class** is any portion of a community marked off from the rest of social status. A **social class** has been defined as an abstract category of persons arranged on levels according to **social status** they posses. There are no firm lines dividing one category from another -

The social class involves three features:

a. Hierarchy of status (always graded order)
b. Recognition of superiority and inferiority and
c. Change and mobility is present

Determinants of social class: In some societies **occupation** and **income** in other **education** and ownership of **material possessions** in some other **family background** may be important criteria. The basis of criteria among the farmers is the **land ownership**

Social interaction: It is dynamic interplay of forces in which contacts between persons and groups results in a modification of the attitudes and behavior of the participants – **Sutherland** 1961

Social processes: Social interaction, which assumes a repetitive pattern in a specific direction, becomes a social process. Social processes refer to **repetitive** forms of behavior which are commonly found in social life. E.g. Cooperation, competition, accommodation and assimilation

LECTURE NO.: 6. CULTURE, DIFFERENT CULTURAL CONCEPTS AND THEIR ROLE IN AGRICULTURAL EXTENSION

Culture: meaning, definitions and different orders of culture:

The **extension education** brings about the changes in the **behavior** complex of the rural people. The behavior is in turn influenced by the cultural factors, extension workers, therefore should have knowledge of the culture of the rural people. *Learned behavior, which has been organized into patterns and is shared and transmitted among the members of society, is known as* ***culture.*** Sociologists have developed the concept of **culture** in order to explain the regularity in human actions. The sociological meaning of the term culture differs sharply from the literary (bookish) use. In conventional (usual) usage, the word culture is employed to designate only the behavior systems that are regarded as refinements such as paintings, music, art etc. But culture also includes all the activities that are **characteristics** of a given group of people

In social science, culture refers to **totality** of what is learned by individuals as members of the society. **Culture** is a way of life, mode of thinking, acting and **feeling**. Culture refers to the distinct way of life of a group of people, a complete design of living. According to **Tylor** culture is the **complex whole**, which includes knowledge, belief, art, moral, law, customs and any other capability and habits acquired by them as **members** of **society.** Culture includes not only the way of making things and doing things, but the pattern of the relationships and attitudes, beliefs and ideas they have and even the feelings with which people respond. In other words culture includes everything the man learns or acquires as member of a particular society. All the members of group share **culture**. All human societies have culture but the contents differ, and all cultures have customs, language, major institutions, and some type of technology, which is shared by the members of the society

According to **Ralph Linton** culture may be the thought in terms of **three** different orders:

Two **overt** (which can be seen) orders of culture are:

1. Material products of industry, implements, tools etc
2. Overt behavioral patterns like customs, folkways etc

One **covert** (which cannot be seen or hidden) order of culture is:

3. Psychological like attitudes, values etc. held by the individuals or groups

The study of culture helps to understand the **behavior** of people in different parts of the world. The desired change cannot be successfully brought about without clear comprehension of the concept of **culture**. Extension worker should have knowledge of elements of culture that are important in relation to his work

Role of culture in Extension:

1. Culture is **dynamic** and continuously **changes** because of internal as well as external forces of stimuli. **Community development** aims at bringing about the changes in the culture of rural people towards desired goals. Scientific understanding of the culture is therefore basic E.g. Improved pig raring in Muslim village is not possible
2. It is possible to record greater success when the improved practices introduced are in **familiar** terms i.e. something that is already present in the culture E.g. Improved plough with iron ploughshare
3. Change is more likely to occur in those aspects of culture where there is **lack of adjustment or stress**, then in those aspects, which are established and fixed. E.g. Introduction of improved practices in areas which are rehabilitated on account of floods or fire
4. Change in **technology** is usually more readily accounted than change in other aspects of culture E.g. Introducing of improved seed of a crop

Ethnocentrism:

Ethnocentrism refers to the **preferential** feeling we have for the way we do things in our culture. We presume that ours is the best of all cultures and the way we do things is the **right way** to do them. This is common characteristic we find among the people of all cultures. This influences the extension activities some times, which we have to understand and safeguard

Customs:

The sociologists have used various terms in order to classify various human acts of behavior. If these various types of human behavior are organized, they are called customs. **Maclever** defined customs as socially **accorded** (agreed) or **accredited** (given) ways of acting

Customs are the **accepted** ways in which people do things together. Customs are socially **prescribed** forms of behavior transmitted by tradition and enforced by social disapproval of its violation (not doing). Customs may also be defined as a habitual form of meeting people. Training the young, supporting the aged etc are some of the customs of society. Our acting, our dressing, our worship are controlled to a great extent by customs. We agree most of the customs of the group to which we belong. Custom is usage (habit) it's essential feature is that it is a generally observed **code of conduct**. Its' sanction (punishment) is **fear** of public opinion. Human behavior is not individualized. It has some definite forms. It occurs in regular fashion. Customs are thought of as being well-established and **difficult** to change. Customs are generally a group action. Unconsciously we conform to the customs of our own society. Folkway if transmitted by tradition and followed generation after generation may become **custom**

The **classification of customs** and their origin are as follows:

Folkways:

- Folkways are **expected** forms of behavior but are not rigidly enforced
- Folkways are the **customary** ways of behaving in society, in which society exerts some force for **conformity**
- Folkways are **recognized** ways of behavior in a society
- The Folkways are socially **acceptable** ways of behavior. The customary norms of society that do not imply moral **sanction** (punishment)**.** Folkways are otherwise called as **Usages** sometimes
- The folkways are the **right** ways to do things because they are the **expected** ways. They do not have more sanctions associated with them. People who do not conform may be subject to criticism but would not be penalized

Examples of folkways are:

- Good manners
- Entering home only after removal of shoes
- Lady touching the feet of her mother-in-law
- Greeting others with folded hands

Thus folkways are accepted as **appropriate** but not insisted upon. Society cannot exercise pressure upon people to conform to regular pattern of behavior. **Folkways** help individuals in a group to order social life in a smooth and harmonious way. People who have similar needs began to satisfy these needs in a similar way in the same environment such actions give rise to **folkways.** Folkways usually arise without prior intention in the process of living. They are the results of frequent **repetition** of petty (little) actions often, by large number of people acting in the same way when faced with some needs. They arise from experience. Non-observance of folkways is not a vital matter, social sanction is relatively mild, but the disapproval is shown by lifted eyebrow expression of moderate surprise or smile

Mores:

Mores are the plural of Latin word '**More**'. The mores are the customs or patterns of behavior, which are regarded by members of social system as **vital** and **essential** to the welfare of the group. They show what is **right** for the welfare of group. Mores may be defined as those customs, which are held to be **essential** to ethical or moral values of people. Mores are the socially **acceptable** ways of behavior that do involve **moral standards** (regulations) and violation of **more** may result in severe **social action** or **sanction**, such as ostracism (exclusion of individual or family from the village or society). Religion provides foundation for **mores** of the society

Examples of Mores:

- Inter-dining of high-cast Hindus with out-caste Hindus
- Honesty is one of the recognized mores of the society
- Saluting the National Flag
- Standing during the playing of National Anthem
- Monogamy (having one wife or husband)
- Women and children first in the event of crises

The term **more** is used for those things that are **ought to be done**. It is used for **positive** actions. Mores are insisted upon individuals. Society exerts pressure to conform the regular pattern and it not followed individual gets penalty from society. Mores are rigidly enforced

Taboos:

Generally the term '**more**' is used for the **positive** action or things that ought to be done but the term '**taboo**' is used for the **negative** action and for the things that one **ought not to do**. Taboo means forbid. It refers to the prohibitions of the types of behavior because of some magical, supernatural (God) or religious sanction

Examples of taboo: Total abstinence (self denial) of eating beef in a Hindu village (eating beef in Hindu religion) and eating pork in Muslim religion

Rituals:

Ritual is prescribed form of behavior for **certain occasions** and certain actions are **designated** in prescribed manner. **Ritual** may be defined as a pattern of behavior or ceremony, which has become the **customary** way of dealing with **certain situations.** Generally it is discussed as an aspect of religion. Religion is found in all established form of activities. It may include prayers. Military organization and other formally organized groups have adhered to a prescribed form of behavior known as **ritualism**

Examples of rituals:

- Celebration of Independence Day
- Celebration of Republic day

Conventions:

These are customs regulating more significant social behavior. Parents generally do not care to leave such learning to chance. Parents instruct their children the conventions though often they (parents) cannot explain why the child must confirm

Examples of Conventions:

- Being polite to others
- Wearing clothes in public
- Dating or courtship (found in western countries) and engagement practices
- Using knife, spoon or fork for eating etc.

Differences between mores and taboos:

Mores	Taboos
Mores refer to positive action	Taboos refer to negative action
Mores are the customs regarded by the members of the society as vital or essential	They are the customs which are forbidden
Things ought to be done	Things ought not to be done
E.g. Monogamy, honesty etc.	E.g. eating of beef in Hindu religion etc.

Differences between mores and folkways:

Mores	Folkways
These are socially acceptable ways of behavior that involve moral standards	These are the customary ways of behaving in society
These are rigidly enforced and if not followed by a person the individual gets severe penalty form the society	Persons who do not conform may be subjected to criticism or be considered 'strange' but would not necessarily penalized
Patterns of behavior which are considered essential by the society	Expected form of behavior but not rigidly enforced
If violated the group or society may be disturbed or divided	If violated will not have severe effect on society
E.g. Monogamy, honesty etc.	E.g. Good manners, greeting others etc.

Lecture No.: 7. Social values, Social control and attitudes - types and their role in agricultural extension

Definitions:

Values are relative importance or preferences we give to any object, idea or content of experience etc. **Value** is defined as anything desired or chosen by someone. **Social values** are relatively enduring (lasting or permanent) awareness plus emotion regarding an object, idea or person – **Green** 1964. **Social values** are abstract and often unconscious assumptions of what is right and important **Young** – 1959.

Attitude: Definitions

Attitude is a positive or negative feeling one has towards any psychological object. **Attitudes** are based up on values and attitudes influence our action positively or negatively. Hence they are covert and not overt

Value system: The values in terms of attitudes taken together as a set form a system, which is called value system of society. E.g. prestige based on caste of individual, status based up on individual's possession of land etc

Role of value system in Extension:

Society places different values on various items which form a part of village life e.g. villagers spend money on daughter's marriage, building a house etc. Extension worker should understand the **value system** in a village and implement his programs in such a way that the programs are not going to interfere with the value system. Extension worker should think of changing the same (values) before introducing his programs

Values and Norms

Norms are closely associated with values but are clearly differentiated from them (values). **Values** are the attitudes, held by the individuals, groups or society as a whole, as to whether material or non-material objects are good, bad, desirable or undesirable. *The **rules** that govern action directed towards achieving values are called **norms.*** **Norms** are the accepted and approved forms of behavior that are based on and consistent with dominant **social values** in society. The values and norms go together

Opinion → Attitude → Norm/Social value

A set of social values will always have an accompanying set of social norms or rules that uphold and support values

E.g. of value: Religious worship and respect to god usually is considered value

E.g. of value system: Religion

Examples of norms: Observance of religious festivals and performance of rituals and worship and other relevant activities are important norms of society towards the value system of religion

Major values prevailing in rural society or Social values

1. **Importance of ascribed (given by somebody) status**: Status of individual is decided by the group to which he belongs. There is an established order of hierarchy of castes in the Indian society
2. **Recognition of inequality**: Caste is still a guiding factor. There are inequalities based on the concept of higher and lower castes which are manifested (brought out) in many ways

3. **Patriarchal tendency**: Father is the head of family. Eldest male member of family has supreme power and tends to act autocratically
4. **Status of women**: There is a tendency towards giving greater respect and recognition to women, but they are supposed to be inferior to men. As far as their sphere of work is concerned it is mostly restricted to home management
5. **Greater male dominance**: Boys receive greater attention than girls. E.g. it is general attitude of parents that daughter(s) need not be highly educated
6. Adherence to well regulated sex relations
7. **Charity**: There is religious significance and approval for the giving of alms (something or money or food item given freely to poor). A person with a charitable disposition is respected
8. **Tendency of non-violence**: Killing of animals expect for the purpose of food is considered to be immoral
9. **Respect for old aged and elders**: There are fixed norms which guide the behavior of individuals towards elders, superiors and old persons
10. **Religious attitude**: People in rural areas are religious. Performance of rituals and ceremonies are common in the traditional way

Types of Values:

1. **Ultimate values**: Ultimate values are often referred as **dominant values**. These values express the general **views of society** towards matters such as the nature of the universe and man relation to it and to his fellowmen. These values are found most easily in **social institutions** such as **religion**, government or the family. E.g. The democratic proceedings expressed in the system of government (democracy). Ultimate values are **abstract** (not specific) and often **not** attainable
2. **Intermediate values**: These values are derived from **ultimate values** and are actually ultimate values that have been rephrased into more reasonable attainable categories. E.g. **Freedom of speech**, adult franchise (choice, religious freedom, free public education, non-discrimination, adequate housing etc.)
3. **Specific values**: The subdivisions of **intermediate** values are called specific values and are almost **unlimited** in number. Specific values must be in conformity with the total value system of which they form the **smallest unit**. E.g. To a farmer with intermediate value of adequate housing the related specific values can be a brick construction with a **flat slab roof**, wide verandah and large court and with provision to livestock housing. If public education is the intermediate value specific values can be the type of school, room and other facilities and content of courses or instructions etc.

Social control:

Definitions:

Social control is the way in which social order coheres (joins together) and maintains itself, how it operates as a whole as a changing equilibrium (balance) – Maclever

Social control is the sum of those methods by which a society tries to influence human behaviour to maintain a given order – Mannheim

Meaning of social control: Social control is an influence exerted by the public or society for promoting the welfare of the group as a whole

Means or types of social control

Social control is classified in to two categories formal and informal

Informal means of social control

1. **Belief**: Belief in religion controls the behaviour to a great extent
2. **Social suggestions**: we suggest the younger generations many ideas like giving the examples of great men, celebration of anniversaries of great people etc
3. **Ideologies**: The communication of ideologies like Ghandhiism, capitalism, communism etc by which the social behaviour of the individuals is controlled
4. **Customs**
5. **Folkways**
6. **Mores**
7. **Religion**
8. **Art** and **literature:** A purposeful classical dance as art and religious epics like bible, Ramayana etc
9. **Humour and Satire**: Cartoons, comics etc as a part of humour and satires as indirect criticism of actions harmful to help in maintaining the social values
10. **Public opinion**: In villages people know each other even otherwise the fear of public criticism and the need of recognition by individuals makes to control his behaviour

Formal means of social control

1. **Law**: Law is a body of rules given by legally authorized bodies and enforced by authorized agencies like police, judiciary etc
2. **Education**: Education prepares the child for social living by removing his wrong attitudes and learning discipline, honesty and what is right or wrong
3. **Coercion (force)**: Physical coercion like imprisonment or death penalty (through law) and non violent coercion like strike boycott or non cooperation (between individuals and groups) are means of social control

Role of social control in society or Need of social control:

1. **To maintain the old order**: The old members of the family enforce their ideas on the children Marriages are settled by the elder members of the family and they influence the behaviour of other members of the family
2. **To establish the social unity**: Without social control the social unity is a dream. The families and society are united because social control regulates behaviour through established norms

3. **To regulate or control individual behaviour**: No two persons are alike and even the children of same parents are not having same attitudes. If an individual is left free to behave in the society it would be reduced to a jungle. Social control protects the social interests by regulating the individuals' behaviour
4. **To provide social sanction**: Social control provides social sanction through customs, folkways, mores etc
5. **To check cultural mal adjustment**: Society is subject to change and individual tries to adjust to the changing society during this process he or she is likely to develop some habits which may not be right or he may become slave of passions e.g. visiting bars, night clubs etc. Social control helps to stop this mal adjustment